



Barnacles

Barnacles are shrimp-related animals that attach themselves to rocks. They filter-feed on ocean water when the tide is high enough to cover them.

Limpets

These small molluscs stay clamped tightly to the rock when the tide is low.

Populations

All the individuals of the same species living and breeding together make up a population—such as these acorn barnacles attached to the rocks.

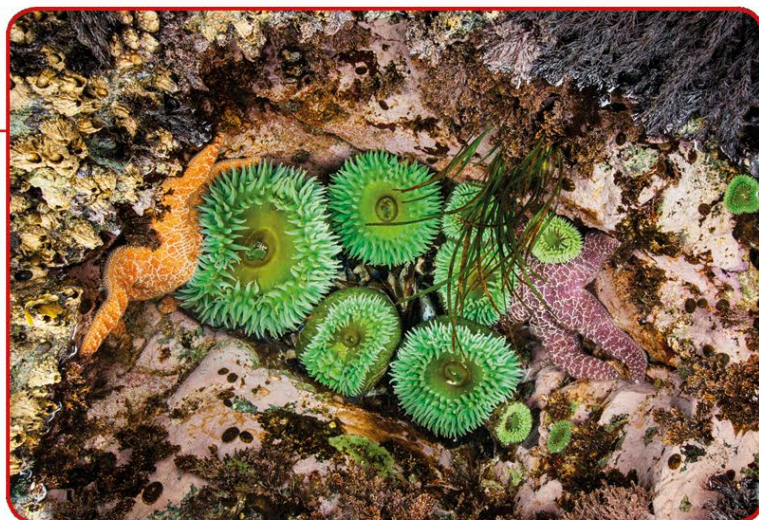


Tidal pool

A tidal pool is a refuge for ocean organisms, helping them stay under water higher up the shore, even when the tide is low.

Communities

All the interacting species in a habitat—such as this colorful collection of anemones, seaweeds, and starfish—make up a community. Communities and the nonliving parts of the environment, such as air, rock, and water, make up an ecosystem.

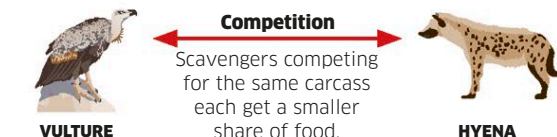
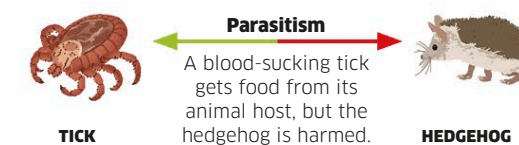


Interactions between species

Within a habitat's community, species interact with one another in many ways. Each kind of interaction is called a symbiosis, and there are several different kinds of partnerships: some helpful, and some harmful.

→ Benefits from relationship

→ Harmed by relationship



Niches

The conditions required by a species (such as water) and the role the species plays in its habitat is called its niche. No two species have exactly the same niche. The sea goldie and the cardinal tetra share some conditions (both need warm temperatures), but not others (one lives in freshwater, the other in saltwater).

